PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Gel Polish & Builder Gel

Cure times in [brackets] follow your gel and lamp maker. Check your state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. No fungus, infection, broken skin or lifting. Medications reviewed.

ALLERGY CHECK

Ask about past reactions to gel, acrylic or glue. Signs of allergy: refer to a dermatologist.

PRE-CARE

Bare, clean nails; foreign product noted. Every gel legal where you work (EU/UK: TPO-free).

SET UP FIRST ☐ Ventilation on ☐ Nitrile gloves ☐ Implements disinfected ☐ New file and buffer ☐ Lamp matched to gel ☐ SDS on hand ☐ Metal bin for wipes

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult**	10 min	Check nails, skin and lifestyle. Agree length, shape, service and price.
2	**Sanitize hands**	2 min	Both sanitize hands. Nitrile gloves on. Offer SPF or UV gloves.
3	**Cuticle prep**	5–10 min	Push back cuticle. Remove non-living tissue only; never cut living skin.
4	**Buff & dehydrate**	5 min	Remove shine lightly with 180+ grit; don't overfile. Dust off, dehydrate.
5	**Primer & base**	5 min	Primer per manufacturer. Thin base, kept off skin. Cure the full [ ] sec.
6	**Builder & apex**	10–20 min	Slip layer, then a bead; float to set the apex. Cure, cleanse, refine.
7	**Color**	10 min	Thin coats, cap the free edge. Clean gel off skin, then cure each layer.
8	**Top coat & cleanse**	5 min	Cap the edge and cure. Wipe the inhibition layer if required. Cuticle oil.
9	**Finish & photos**	5 min	Check sidewalls, free edge and cuticle line. After photos in good light.
10	**Aftercare & rebook**	5 min	Review aftercare and card. Soak-off in [2–3] weeks, infill in [3–4].
11	**Removal**	15–20 min	File off top coat. Acetone wraps [10–15] min; push gently. Never pry.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Thin, even coats; free edge capped; clean cuticle line
- Matched lamp, full cure time, output checked
- No uncured gel on skin; clean up before every cure
- Uncured gel wipes go in a sealed metal bin

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Uncured gel on skin: remove with cleanser on a lint-free wipe, then wash with soap and water.
- Itching, redness or swelling: stop, soak off, refer to a dermatologist. No gel until cleared.
- Nick or bleeding: stop, apply pressure with clean gauze, discard the item. No product on broken skin.
- Heat spike in the lamp: pull the hand out, then cure in short bursts or use a lower-heat lamp.
- Product in the eye: flush with eyewash for 15 minutes, then seek medical care.
- Lifting with a green spot or sore fold: don't cover it. Remove, and refer if it looks infected.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Gel brand · lot	Shade(s)	Lamp · cure time	Primer used
Shape · length	**Skin & nail check**	**SPF or gloves**	**Next fill · initials**